Daniel Throssell's

Email Copywriting Compendium

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How To Make Your $101 Back On This *Compendium* ASAP!

Dear Reader,

I don't know what finally convinced you to invest $101 in this report, but…

You, my friend, have just
HIT THE JACKPOT!

The report you are now lucky enough to own is, I believe, one of the most valuable documents you will ever possess in your copywriting journey.

You see, as I type these words, I'm sitting right in front of a bookshelf crammed with many of the great copywriting books that have inspired me and taught me the sacred craft of copywriting: *Scientific Advertising* by Claude Hopkins. *The Robert Collier Letter Book*. *Tested Advertising Methods* by John Caples. *Kick-Ass Copywriting Secrets* by John Carlton. Ben Settle's *Email Players Skhema Book*. And many more. But in my opinion…

This *Compendium* Is More Valuable
Than ALL Of Them!

…okay, okay, fine. *Maybe* I'm biased. (I'll settle for equal footing.) But in all seriousness, there are several advantages this *Compendium* has that no other book I know of has:

First … it's SHORT. This is not a "book" that will take you several days—or heck, several *hours*—to read. You can read this entire thing in one sitting, in the next half hour or so. And then—you can start *using* what you've learned, immediately, to start making sales.

Second … it's up to date. As I write this, this is now the third update to this report in five years. I still send an email to my email list *every single day*, as I have for the past 5+ years, and so everything you are about to read is something that is working *right now*.

And finally…

You Will NOT Find The "New, Fun Way" For Writing Emails
That I Teach In This Report *Anywhere Else*!

Now, I'm *not* saying every idea in this *Compendium* is original to me. (Most are not.) **But I have taken the very *best* ideas of every other great copywriter I have studied … and combined them with my *own* original ideas & innovations … into a unique copywriting 'system' unlike any I have ever seen before.** And part of the reason for that is:

My Philosophy Is NOT
A "How-To" Guide.

Actually—as you will see from (literally) Rule #1—I despise one-size-fits-all prescriptions for copywriting. And so instead, **my philosophy is made up of 101 "Rules"** that guide the way I think, write emails, and even run my business.

Some of my rules will sound similar to advice you have heard. Others will fly in the face of conventional wisdom (*try Rules #23, #24, or #34 on most email marketers and watch their reaction!*). But each one has had to earn its place here.

The beauty of this approach is that it does not 'box you in', or make you a clone of me. Rather, it gives you a tested *framework* to build upon as you create your *own* unique style, brand, voice, character, and world via email!

So, here's my recommendation:

First, read through this report in one sitting. It's short enough that you can do that. (You can take notes on any Rules that catch your eye, if you wish.) **But the *important* thing is that you read the whole thing ASAP.** Because once you do that…

Literally EVERY Email I Send You Becomes
A Free, Ongoing Education Into Email Copywriting!

Since every email I send is a real, LIVE demonstration of these very Rules … meaning not only will you now know "how the magic trick is done", but **you will also be able to analyse your OWN reaction to these techniques as a reader & customer**, which will 'ingrain' these Rules into you better than *any* amount of re-reading will.

Of course, you may still want to reference this *Compendium* again from time to time. So **I also suggest printing a copy out**, and keeping it on your desk for 'quick reference'. The Rule-based layout is designed so that you can 'dip into' this and quickly consult it any time you need advice, or when you're writing an email.

If you do these two simple things … and importantly, start *applying* what you learn in your own emails (or your clients' emails) … **I firmly believe you will make back the $101 you invested in this report many, many times over.** Because I was not exaggerating when I said that writing emails the new, fun way I'm about to show you can help you write emails so good, people literally send you *fan mail* along with their money. It's a great feeling … and I can't wait for you to experience it.

If you're ready, turn the page and let the fun begin…

Daniel Throssell

Dear Old Self:

Yo! It's Future-Daniel here, writing from your future mansion in Japan.

...juuuust kidding, we still have that same house in Perth. Anyway, listen. If my time-travel calculations are correct, you're currently reading this in 2016, at the start of your copywriting career.

Sorry to be frank, but I've read your work and I think you suck.

I, on the other hand, am currently the best copywriter in ... Australia. (Okay, so there are a few copywriters I need to 'take out' before I can claim the entire world, but still — beats your little upwork gigs, punk.)

But I always want to improve. So I've come up with a genius plan: I have attached to this time-carrier-pigeon a top-secret list of the 101 rules I've personally discovered for writing amazing emails. I figured that by sending them to my <u>past</u> self, I'd instantly become better in the <u>present</u>. But while I wait to see if that works, right now I want to share the 102nd and <u>MOST</u> important rule of all, and that is that you must NEVER—

<u>WHOA</u>, hang on, it's working! I already feel the benefit of many years' EXTRA experience pouring into my brain! This is amazing!!!

I ... feel like I was about to say something important but I can't remember. So ... uh ... enjoy the compendium.

Your ... future self,

~~2021~~ ~~2022~~ 2025 Daniel Throssell (yes, I keep updating this thing...)

P.S. Around 2020, start stocking up on toilet paper and hand sanitiser. Oh gosh ... NO, that does <u>NOT</u> mean what you think it does! We, uh, still have toilets. Oh, and also — buy PERSUASIVEPAGE.COM, and tell anyone who wants to see all these rules 'in action' to go subscribe there for the emails...

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Email Copywriting Compendium

1. **The Most Important Word In Copywriting Is…**
   "FREE!" … just kidding. It's **context.** Literally every single thing that anyone 'teaches' about copywriting — 'best practices', 'rules', 'proven templates', 'systems', and anything else — is context-dependent. **There is nothing that works the same way in every context, to every market, at all times.** Every "best practice" you read about in old books was invented by someone's testing and observation, and didn't exist before that. And … that includes the 100 rules that follow this one. Understanding this rule alone can save you from a life of blindly following other people's teachings, and never being visionary enough to try something new that could end up working extremely well for *your* case.

2. **The Elements Of Must-Read Marketing Email Lists**
   From studying dozens of email lists that I feel 'get it right', I put together the following list of elements that make an email list 'must-read'. Many are fleshed out into 'rules' in their own right throughout this *Compendium*. You don't need them all, but the more your emails have, the better. Here it is for your edification:

   a. Radically different, thought-elevating insights on a topic
   b. The impression of being at the 'cutting edge' of your topic and sharing things people would be missing out on if they didn't read (e.g. the stock analyst out there 'kicking rocks', visiting factories, and flying places to have the hottest tips on new stocks)
   c. A strong and trustworthy opinion on developing news and trends in the topic — especially if it's controversial
   d. A good sense of humour
   e. A unique individual writing style with a distinctive 'voice'
   f. Excellent storytelling
   g. Personal, real insights into the day-to-day life of the narrator or behind the scenes of the business, with a well-developed cast of recurring 'characters'
   h. A voyeuristic look into the dream lifestyle of the reader (e.g. a successful freelance copywriter who writes about their exploits landing clients, writing killer sales letters, and making lots of money)
   i. Precise insight into your market's pain points and struggles and regular discussion around them
   j. The occasional good old-fashioned rant

3. **Before You Send Any Email, Ask This …**
   Never send an email without asking: **"Is this worth my reader stopping what they are doing to read this email?"** If the answer is no, rewrite or scrap the email. Treat your readers' time and attention as sacred. Respect it by only sending them emails *you* would like to get if you were in their shoes.

4. **Never Sell Out Your List**
   You should *always* prioritise the relationship with your list above any quick sale. That means not spamming them with sales they won't appreciate … sending them things they don't value … referring or recommending things just because you get a cut (and not because your list will actually find them useful) … or so on. Take a 5-year view of your list, rather than a 5-week one.

5. **"Value" Does Not Mean "Teaching"**
   Every email you send must be valuable to someone. But value does not only come from teaching or even from tips. Value can be conveyed in other ways. **One of the most important forms of value is *entertainment*. A good story, joke, rant, or fight is valuable to a reader, in the same way that people happily exchange money to watch movies or see comedians or attend sports matches.** In fact, everything you *ever* do must be entertaining. These days entertainment is so ubiquitous and easy to access … that even valuable information *must* be wrapped in 'entertainment' if you want people to consume it.

6. **More Info Does Not Equal More Value**
   In most cases, an abundance of information is *not* valuable for most people. They value curation and consumability. So one short, focused tip is more effective than a meaty, 1,500 word 'how-to' email. Save your meatiest stuff for your paid products. Your emails should be short, pithy, and be about ONE idea.

7. **If You Want To Help Someone, Make Them Pay**
   People value things in proportion to what they pay for them. Giving people something for free lessens their respect for its value — and makes it far less likely they will ever use it. **You *must* extract a cost from someone if you want them to value and implement what you teach them. The more important the information, the more you must charge to make people value it.** And so obviously, free email is not the medium for giving away your best info, because people will not value what they got in an email for free.

8. **The Goal Of Email Marketing: To Build "Know, Like, Trust, Revere"**
   There's a common model for marketing that says your goal should be to get customers who "know, like and trust" your brand. Well, my approach to email

copywriting adds a fourth: "revere" (*and yes, this know/like/trust/revere model is an original concept of mine, in case you see someone ripping me off on Twitter somewhere*). The point is, the goal of your email marketing strategy should be to: a) **make people *know* you better** (Rule #21) … b) ***like* you more** (this is probably the least important of the four — people will still buy from you if they don't like you — but it doesn't hurt) … c) ***trust* you** to tell them the truth and sell them high-quality offers that genuinely improve their lives (Rule #4) … and d) ***revere* you** as an authority and, more importantly, a *celebrity* in your niche (Rule #24). If you are doing at least one of those four things with each email you send, you are well on your way to building a far more loyal, engaged, responsive customer base.

9. **The Ideal Email Length…**
   …does not really exist (see the next rule and Rule #1). However, **for my own list my *personal* preference is to aim for 1,000 words most days**. (In earlier versions of this report I used to say 500 words was my goal, and for years it was; but I've gotten better at writing long emails that are still thoroughly entertaining — see the next rule.) But **I'd say closer to 500 words is better for most email lists.** And in general, the shorter, the better. You should NEVER want someone to leave one of your emails before they've finished reading it; it forms very bad associations with reading your emails. Leave people hungry and they'll come back; overfill them once and they'll remember you made them feel ill.

10. **A Word Count Is A Lyin' Thing**
    That said, there are ways to make long emails *feel* shorter. One is to make them ridiculously fun. For example, some of my wilder, fantastical story-based emails where I paint hilarious or ridiculous stories — or emails where I am giving a good old 'beatdown' to a troll — end up running over 1,000 words … but they feel very quick because they are so entertaining. People can and will read a lot more when they're having fun.

11. **Are You Smarter Than A 5th Grader? … Don't Be**
    A second way to make emails feel shorter and easier to read is to keep your grade level low. Before you send, use Hemingway App and grade your email. I recommend staying to Grade 5 or lower. Break up sentences. Use line breaks. Use smaller words. Make it easy and simple to read. (Like I'm doing right now.) In the beginning you'll have to work at this. Eventually it becomes natural.

12. **The THREE Hurdles To Getting Your Email Read**
    Contrary to popular opinion … people actually make THREE decisions on whether to read an email, not one. The first is obviously the decision to open the email — which they make based on your subject line and sender name. But this doesn't mean they'll read the email. You still have two more hurdles to clear…

13. **The Second Hurdle To Getting Your Email Read**
    The second is making someone decide to begin reading — which they decide mainly by quickly scanning how many words they can see on the screen. Their brain subconsciously assesses the perceived effort of reading the email. The more words it can see (like in a plain-text email on desktop without font wrapping), the more likely it is to think 'too hard!' and either skim or skip the email. This is where limiting the width of your columns, and using larger font, can help. **NOTE:** This doesn't mean you HAVE to avoid plain-text or hard-to-read layouts. Some people (e.g. Ben Settle) do this deliberately to add friction and get more engaged readers. Just know the trade-off, and make an informed decision.

14. **The Third Hurdle To Getting Your Email Read**
    The third is the decision to keep reading after the first few lines — which they make by how interesting your lead is. If it feels like you're about to lead into a looooong story or explanation — especially when you have a habit of telling stories that end up having nothing to do with the 'point' of the email — many people will 'check out'. Again, this doesn't mean you must always pander to busy people by never telling stories. But for this reason **I always try and make my first line very grabby … or at least something that implies something fun or valuable is coming in the email.**

15. **Emails Are Not Sales Letters**
    Never put the burden of a sales letter on a single email. **One email should not and cannot take someone from cold to sold.** Emails work best with a cumulative effect over time. For example, I once reviewed a student's email that told the story of how he had seen his mother sick, and it inspired him to go on a journey to find the best ingredients, and he met a scientist, and together they formulated the product, and … you get the drift. It was a whole sales letter story. But this is not what emails are good for. Only a fraction of people will open your email. A smaller fraction still will read it. Telling your entire sales message in one email is a bad idea. Do it over time.

16. **Good Email Marketing Is An (Asymmetrical) Relationship**
    As I've already hinted in several rules, good email marketing is much closer to a *relationship* than the spammy, transactional approach many businesses have to their email lists. That said, it's also a very strange relationship … as it's not possible for YOU to know 10,000+ subscribers the way they can all know you by reading

your emails. So more precisely, **good email marketing is about building a character your readers feel they have a relationship with.** (Compare Rules #21-#23.) That is, you are trying to walk the tightrope of having 10,000+ people intimately know, like, trust and revere you (or your email 'character'), while also acknowledging that there is no way you can return that intimacy towards each of them. **You know you are doing it right when people reply to your emails and tell you things about themselves, stories of theirs, related things your email reminded them of, etc.** because this is a sign they feel they have a relationship with you.

17. **Sell In Every Email**
Every email you send should include a link to an offer you sell, or at *least* a call-to-action. Some people recoil from this because they think that to build a relationship, you need to send "engagement" or "value" emails that sell nothing. This is ridiculous! I've sold in almost every single email I've ever sent to my list … and I get *massive* engagement. My secret? I don't treat "sales" emails any differently to "engagement" emails. Think of it this way: **if you're writing amazing content, and solving a problem for someone, and building a relationship with them, they are going to WANT you to pitch them something.** Why wouldn't they? If you just gave them something that was incredible, why would they not want to be offered more? Honestly, you're just projecting your own mental blocks onto other people if you don't include a CTA after some awesome content. **And if the content isn't awesome enough that it has people wanting to buy something from you after it, you shouldn't be sharing it. Write better content that is worthy of a pitch.** But…

18. **Don't Sell *Hard* In Every Email**
While I recommend selling in every email … **90% of the time you should be *soft* selling**. In other words, while you include a link to an offer, and might even talk about how great the offer is, you don't pitch it aggressively. The option to buy is there if someone wants to buy that day; but if not, you are just trying to build the desire to buy *over time*. Then, at certain intervals, you can do short sales (with discounts, premiums, or some other limited-time incentive) where you actually push harder for the sale. (Rules #88-#100 briefly cover how to run these limited-time sales, though my course *Campaign Conqueror* is the full blueprint.) If you hard-sell every day and neglect relationship-building, you'll burn out your list quickly. But if you do it this way, you can nurture your list while regularly 'harvesting' the desire you're building up.

19. **Readers WANT To See "You" In Your Emails**
A popular podcaster once asked me: Doesn't sharing personal stuff before the 'value' in your email just turn people off and make them think, 'I don't care, just get to the content?' Not if you do it right. If anything, it's the OPPOSITE: People open

their inbox because they are BORED. If you strip out all your personality and just "get to the content", your emails will be boring and you'll stay unread.

20. **"Make Characters Of The People In Your Life"**
Scott Pape taught me this rule, and it's become one of the guiding philosophies behind my entire email philosophy. The idea is that you should **take the people in your life and turn them into characters who feature in your stories**. Just like people enjoy watching shows where they grow to love the characters, so you want the characters in your life to feature in your emails.

21. **Readers Should Know You Better After Every Email**
The single most important "character" to develop is your *own*. **And so, I apply a rule to every email I write: "Will someone know me better after reading this?"** Note that this does not mean they LIKE me more. Many things about me are *unlikeable* for some — my sense of humour, my kid stories, my Christianity, my politically incorrect stances on things like non-native copywriters, my abrasiveness, my mockery of trolls, etc. But they're all *developing my character* more deeply (Rules #16 & #23). That's why every email of mine has at least some quip, or story, or fact about me, or opinion on something: I ALWAYS want you to leave an email knowing "Daniel Throssell" better.

22. **Caricature Everyone — Including Yourself**
When you're featuring characters in your stories, don't leave people as they are. **Just like a writer writes interesting characters, you should amplify the interesting parts of people into caricatures of who they are. And this includes yourself, too.** The 'you' in your stories should be an exaggerated, caricatured, version of who you are in real life.

23. **Don't "Be You" When You're Writing Emails**
One of the most common pieces of advice I hear given for personal branding is: "Just be yourself!" But this is terrible advice, at least for writing emails my way. **You should have a manufactured version of yourself — an "email persona" — that you play, like putting on a mask.** And when you write your emails, you shouldn't "be yourself" — you should be THAT persona. (Some people think this is being 'inauthentic', but the truth is, you *already* play a different version of 'you' to everyone in your life — your kids, your spouse, your siblings, your church, your workmates, your school friends, your online followers — this is just adding one more 'you' to that list.) This persona is usually based on aspects of your real personality — but it allows you to be more interesting, controversial, and entertaining than your "usual" self, while also helping you stay 'detached' from the criticism and attacks that will inevitably come your way. (This is not the same as

Rule #22, which deals with characterisation within stories you tell about your real-life self; my "Rule #22" character in my stories is a rather hapless, wimpy introvert, whereas my "Rule #23" persona is the self-aggrandising, megalomaniacal, controversial, offensive, evil-villain "Emperor of Copyland" act I play when I write my emails.)

24. **A Weird Trick To Psychologically Abuse Your Readers Into Revering You**
A sneaky trick I use to reinforce my status to my list (Rule #8) is to paint myself as a character in stories who is some form of an authority figure over them. So I will (jokingly, of course) make myself a teacher while they're a student; a kidnapper when they're the prisoner; the Emperor of Copyland whereas they are a mere subject; and so on. Admittedly this is weird, and it probably won't work for people who don't have my personality and style. Maybe it won't work for *anyone* who isn't me. But at least now you know why I seem like such a psycho.

25. **Exaggeration Is The Most Amazing, Incredible Technique In The History Of Storytelling And There Has NEVER Been Anything Better!!!**
Most boring stories copywriters tell in emails could do with a good whack of exaggeration. Amplify the emotion in words. Turn statements into screams. Make people *instantly* teleport to other places in a room before your eyes when they're excited. "Burst into" rooms, don't "enter" them. You're not surprised; your eyes are wide with shock. Be *exciting*. Exaggerate. People love it.

26. **Write Emails "Based On A True Story"**
Very rarely does life actually turn out the way a storyteller would tell it. **So I hereby give you permission to take creative license with your stories and write the best *story*, not the most accurate depiction of what happened.** Compress timelines if you need to. Eliminate characters when they're not necessary. Rewrite dialogue if it makes it clearer or funnier. Don't *lie* about stuff, especially to make yourself look better. But I have no hesitation in rewriting my stories to make them more entertaining (and thus more *valuable*, remember?) to my reader. My philosophy is "based on a true story".

27. **Always Be On The Lookout For Story Ideas**
Most people have several story-worthy moments each day. If you can't find them, it's probably because you're looking for BIG things. But most of my good stories have come from fairly everyday events. The time I had to silently scare a random snotty kid at McDonald's so he'd stop touching my kids' food … the time my "wind-proof" umbrella failed me in the middle of a storm … the time I left my phone in my car and had to find a way to call my wife in the middle of the city, while being too introverted to ask anyone for their phone … the time I sent deeply personal

fan-mail to a copywriter and got a brain-dead VA with a templated response asking if she could "share it with the team" … and many other "everyday" things like that. These things make more relatable, more enjoyable story ideas than "big" stories like quitting your job. I constantly note these ideas down on the Notes app on my phone. As you do this, your 'story sense' will get better, and you will begin to get faster at seeing how a scene in your life could be turned into a story.

28. **The "Triforce" Of Email Leads: Relevant, Entertaining, Brief**
Let's say you're writing a typical sales email with a lead, that then pivots to a "tip" or "lesson" or some other light "value", and then pivots to a sales pitch. **There are three factors you need to keep in mind for the lead of your email: a) relevance to your tip/lesson/pitch; b) entertainment value; and c) brevity.** If your lead falls short in any of these three areas, you must compensate in the other two. For example: I write daily emails containing copywriting tips and pitches for copywriting products — but many of my email leads are stories about my daily life, e.g. something my kids did. That's not super *relevant* to copywriting, so I have to either make the story quick (brevity) — or make it very entertaining. Otherwise, readers wonder "why am I reading this?" **For each email, ask: "Is the lead of this email relevant to the tip/pitch at the end? Is it entertaining? And is it quick to read?" And make sure you can say "yes" to at least two.**

29. **Not Every Sales Email Needs A Fresh Personal Story**
Personal stories told in "real time" (i.e. "this just happened to me today") are my #1 favourite way to write emails, but you can't always get them (especially if you're writing for a client). Thankfully there are plenty of other things you can do if you don't have a fresh story:
    a. Tell a past story from your life
    b. Tell someone else's story, framed through you (e.g. introduce the story by talking about YOUR relation to it, even if it's just the technique I teach in Rule #41)
    c. Take a breaking global news item and put your 'twist' on it (e.g. "What Donald Trump's New Policy Means For Copywriters") — but see Rules #65-66
    d. Take an industry news item and report on it
    e. Answer a reader question you got
    f. Feature an amusing/dumb/hater email you received (Rule #49)
    g. Rant about something you're passionate about (where possible, you should try doing a *funny* rant like a comedian might, but if you don't know how, it's okay to just get passionate, as long as you remember Rule #47)
    h. Pick a fight with a common misconception/popular philosophy in your industry you think is dumb

i. And more … this isn't an exhaustive list, but it shows you don't *only* need to rely on personal stories to write great emails.

30. **The Sitcom Secret Behind Telling Great Stories In Emails**
If you do tell personal stories in your emails, you need to understand *why*. **We tell stories in emails NOT to relate an interesting series of events … *but to flesh out our own character by showing how they RESPOND to those events.*** Let me give you an example. In my *Inbox Detonator Bunker* there's a review of an email selling a marketing agency's services. My student took the "story + tip" approach. He opened the email with a story about how he'd gone hiking in the woods with his dad … had gotten a bit spooked … turned around … and later found out there was a grizzly bear sighted in the exact place they were about to go to. It was okay as far as stories go. But the problem was, the story was all about bears. He talked about how bears are scary, how they can smell you far away, how they kill people, etc. … but the story didn't talk much about *his* reactions. **Which defeats the entire purpose of telling a story in your emails: to tell the reader something about the *main characters.*** Think of how a sitcom (or any TV show) works. You have your cast of characters … and in each episode they face different challenges, trials or situations. You bond to the characters because you watch how they navigate those trials, and it tells you something about the character. And over time you learn who they are by watching how they react to events in their life. It's the same with the stories I tell in my emails. In my reactions to the events that befall me, you learn about my personality; my sense of humour; my beliefs; my quirks; and so on. This ties in with Rule #21. **Keep this in mind when you're writing stories, and ask: am I casting myself as the character I want my readers to perceive me as?**

31. **Finding The Balance Between Telling Stories About Yourself And Talking About The Reader**
One of the big things that confuses copywriters is "how do I balance telling 'me-focused' stories about myself/the brand with writing 'you, you, you' stuff that's interesting to the reader?" The answer is that **if you build a relationship with your list, you and your stories *become* interesting to them**. The more you can build a relationship and make your customers actually care about you as a brand, the more they will want to hear your stories. It is somewhat of a virtuous circle. And of course (remember Rule #28), if you tell stories relevant to your business and not just your personal life, you don't really have to "choose".

32. **The "Small Business Owner Model" For Relationship-Based Emails**
An approach I find helpful for writing regular emails for businesses is this: **Picture the business (even if it's digital) as a brick-and-mortar store with the owner working behind the counter. Then think of the emails as conversations the**

business owner has with the regular customers who come in. So a bike shop could write emails about the amazing new tyres that a distributor just released and how they're ordering a test batch; the argument the owner had with the distributor from China this morning; the awesome new set of mountain bikes that just arrived; or how they took one of their models for a test ride on the weekend and it performed fantastically. Just picture a small business you visit, where you have a good relationship with the owner, and you have a great model for how to write emails.

33. **Regular Broadcasts Are Best Written sdrawkcaB** **(btw that's 'Backwards' ... backwards)**
A student of mine who runs a guitar teaching business, and sends new sales emails a few times a week, once told me he was spending way too long writing his emails. I told him he was doing it the wrong way around: he was starting with something to sell, and then working back to find a good 'hook' to start the email. I suggested doing what I do, which is to write my emails 'in reverse': **start with a new or interesting thing you want to talk about, and *then* figure out what you're going to pitch (and how you'll transition to that pitch)**. For example, most days I will just have an idea for an email — often, a story moment from my day — and I'll start writing it out. (I taught my actual process for doing this in Adventure #20 of *Adventures in Copyland*.) Then, and only then, I'll think about how I can 'pivot' into a tip, and a sales pitch. This takes practice at working out how to spot opportunities to teach and sell from your stories, but once you get good at it, the emails you write are MUCH more engaging and effective.

34. **Don't "Write Like You're Writing To A Friend"**
"Write like you would to a friend" is a common tip for writing emails. But *none* of my emails truly sound like emails I'd write to an actual friend. If anything, the way I think of it is as **writing an entertainment column for a newspaper or magazine**. I almost never use a personalised salutation; I never ask questions of the reader; I tell stories (or pull email 'stunts') that are far more contrived than I would ever send to an actual friend; and in fact, I sometimes even violate the rule to write "you", and I will occasionally address my audience *in the aggregate* with something like "all of you" — which is supposed to be a huge no-no! Good emails *don't* have to sound exactly like they're written to a friend.

35. **Don't Use Questions In Sales Emails**
Using questions to open sales emails is a tell of an inexperienced copywriter. By questions I mean things like: "Do you struggle with X?" "Have you ever wished you could Y?" These sound like an amateur sales spiel — not something you should send to a list you are building a relationship with. **Weak copywriters use questions; strong copywriters use stories.** Instead of opening with "*Do you wish you could get rid of your nagging belly fat?*", try something like "*This morning I read a crazy story about a guy who got fired from his job for being too fat…*" Both will hook the same audience (overweight men), but one just feels like a pitch, whereas the other is entertaining and builds a relationship.

36. **How To Use Stories To Sell**
Most of the stories I tell in emails are designed to entertain and build a relationship (and maybe to pivot into a soft pitch), but not really to sell that hard (Rule #18). And that's okay! But if you want to really *sell* with a story, one thing matters above all: **The story must plant an *idea* in the reader's mind that makes them desire, or believe they need, the product.** For example, if I were trying to sell my *Upwork in One Hour* course — which contains a lesson on how to navigate client calls, which are incredibly intimidating for a new copywriter — I might relate a story of a time when I had a client call that was a total train wreck, and the client asked me questions I couldn't answer, and I was humiliated. Not only would such a story be irresistible for my target audience of freelance copywriters, but it also plants the idea: "*I need to know how to do client calls so that never happens to me*". That would make a perfect lead for a sales email where I sell *Upwork in One Hour* because it contains a lesson on that. In short: **If you want your email to sell, don't just use any random story. Pick a story that "plants" (like the movie *Inception*) the *idea* you need someone to believe in order to want the product.**

37. **How To Never Run Out Of Email Ideas, Part I**
There are many ways to come up with email ideas, even if you're writing as much as daily. One is similar to what Ben Settle calls his 'Villains Gallery': make a long list of the pains, frustrations and fears that afflict your audience; and also, the enemies you fight against on their behalf (fat-cat bankers, the "gurus" in your industry, fad diets, Big Pharma, whatever). And then use each of those as themes for different emails. This works because your audience will never get tired of hearing about their problems and tips for how to solve them.

38. **How To Never Run Out Of Email Ideas, Part II**
The second way to have an endless supply of ideas is to take inspiration from the one industry which never has and never will run out of ideas: news and commentary. Think about it. **Every news outlet in history has created content**

every single day for its entire existence. And they will never run out. Why? Because they just talk about new developments. You can do the same. Keep up to date with news that affects your field, and offer your commentary on it. Talk about what you think of it; rant about it; break it down for your audience and tell them what it means for them. And it doesn't have to be news for your niche; it can be *any* news. If you're an expert in your topic, you should be able to find applications for your topic in almost anything.

39. **How To Never Run Out Of Email Ideas, Part III**
A third way to never run out of email ideas is to lurk Reddit, forums, etc. where your market hangs out, and take the trending or top posts. These usually make for excellent email material. I show exactly how to do this kind of thing in my *Market Detective* course.

40. **How To Never Run Out Of Email Ideas, Part IV**
An excellent way to get content for emails is to reprint and reply to emails from your email list. The weirder, angrier, or more opinionated it is, the better. **People can't resist reading other people's comments and opinions.** It's the same psychology behind why we spend so long reading the comments under news articles and YouTube videos, or why talkback radio is so popular, or why there have always been 'Letters to the Editor' sections in newspapers. This works especially well if the letter is disagreeing with (or critical of) you, because that makes conflict (Rule #48).

41. **The Simple Email Opener For Using Other People's Stories In Sales Emails**
If you find a good story you want to use in an email, simply introduce it by saying something like: "I was reading a story the other day about a guy who…" or "A friend of mine recently told me about a problem…" or "I heard about a girl that…" or even just "True story:" or "You won't believe this story:" or something like that, and just launch right into it. It grips people, throws them straight into the story, and they basically can't stop reading.

42. **Elevate People's Thinking**
If you want your emails to be must-read (see Rule #2), you must offer bold new perspectives on your topic that change the way people see it. In my *Inbox Detonator Bunker* I have a review of an email whose 'tip' was to 'jump up and down' when you felt low-energy. I said this was obvious and low-value. **The best insights blow someone's mind and make them say "oh my gosh, that makes so much sense!"** An example of how I've done this is writing about "why bullets in sales emails don't work anymore". This challenged copywriting dogma and yet I gave some fascinating reasons behind it (see Rule #85). I got replies from people telling me it blew their

mind. That is the kind of reaction you want. To do this, of course, **you need to truly have a deep expertise in your market (or your client must), and have a contrarian perspective worth sharing**. There are no 'hacks' to this. But that is why it's so effective. When your insights elevate someone's thinking, they will forever remember that you were the one who did it, and they will be fiercely loyal to your brand.

43. **Use Pain And Fear To Sell Like Hell (Literally)**
A lot of copywriters are scared of the idea of using pain and fear to sell. Screw that. Horror stories are one of the most effective email genres in existence. Humans are psychologically hard-wired to be more persuaded by horror stories than anything else in the world. It's why Christianity teaches a vivid, literal, fiery hell (well, that and the fact that it's *true*, but so much the better to persuade with…). It's why so many cultures have legends designed to terrify children into not doing bad things. **When you show someone a clear, horrific vision of the awful fate that awaits them if they don't use your solution, you don't have to sell. They persuade *themselves* that they need your product.** An example: once I read a blog post by musician Adam Young about his experience with kidney stones. He described the utterly agonising pain — so bad that you'd just fall down and start crying. He described the ordeal of feeling it start in his back … having to go to hospital … and the utter agony of passing the stone. And then he said the doctor had told him to drink water to avoid any more. You know what? I'd never drank as much water as I did in the days after reading that blog post. And that wasn't even a sales email! That's why it's so important to **find your market's horror stories, show them to the reader, and then show them that your product is the way out.** My *Market Detective* course goes into a lot more detail on this. (Note, remember Rule #1: this tactic doesn't work equally well for *every* product. But for products that solve a fundamental fear, pain or problem for someone, it's the most effective type of sales pitch you can write.)

44. **Make Your Emails Taste Like Diet Coke**
In the news there's a saying: if it bleeds, it leads. And so 90% of the news people see in the media is designed to make them feel bad. Bad news is like high-sodium junk food. People can't help but binge. (It's why you had people watching daily COVID case counts on the news for years — people just can't peel their eyes away from stuff that scares them.) But it leaves them feeling thirsty. And they will ALWAYS try and quench that thirst with something refreshing or entertaining. **So if your marketing is the good news, the laugh, the smile in their day … you will be where they WANT to go when they've had enough of the bad news.**

45. **Don't Make People Feel Bad In Emails**
As a corollary, be very careful about getting heavy or serious — people prefer something fun and lighthearted in their inbox. In my *Inbox Detonator Bunker* I reviewed an email that walked the reader through the plot of the movie 127 Hours — where the main character cuts his own arm off — in painstaking detail. It was an awful email to read as it made the reader feel totally uncomfortable. This is *never* a good idea. Sadly, it's the same for email lists that regularly try to guilt people into giving to charities ("look at this poor hungry child") or other (quite worthy) causes. **You can do it once in a while, but if you constantly make people feel sad or guilty or uncomfortable, they will stop reading your emails.** I once scrapped a subject line "Disappointed in you" because while I thought it would work well (and obviously, it quickly explained why I wasn't actually disappointed in the *reader*), they would still experience the discomfort of reading that for a few seconds … and I didn't want that negativity associated with the act of opening my emails.

46. **Uh … *Make* People Feel Bad In Emails?**
How do you reconcile the last two points with the idea of painting horrible visions and digging into pains? Let me clarify. When we're painting horror stories, or talking about their struggles, we're not just saying "your life sucks, haha, bye". We need to write with *empathy* and show that we understand their pains … and that we can help them fix it. **There is inherent *hope* when someone nails our exact pain points in an email, just like there is a sense of hope when the ER doctor diagnoses your exact symptoms — because it means they can help!** Also, if we express pain points as *stories* — like "I heard this crazy story about a girl who just couldn't get a date …" — then we're still targeting their pains (they can see themselves in the horror story) but it's still a story. So it's still entertaining, right? This is the distinction.

47. **Don't Show Weakness**
If you show weakness, you will attract sympathy and pity from people who want to help you — instead of people who see you as somebody who could help them. **So don't be sullen, vulnerable, rattled or upset in your emails.** Part of your job as a professional is to stay in character when you write. There are exceptions, of course — moments of tragedy may call for a rare glimpse of grief, or you might get righteously angry for a good cause. **But you must always be in control of the character you are projecting** (Rule #23). Never show chinks in your armour just because you let emotion get the better of you.

48. **Fights Get More Attention Than Anything Else**
There is a basic drive in humans to want to watch fights and pick a side. **The single best way to whip up a frenzy of attention, controversy and engagement in your**

emails is to pick a fight with someone. The more 'real' the fight, the bigger the egos, and the higher-profile the people involved, the more attention it gets. For example, back in 2020 a prominent YouTuber made a stir in the copywriting community for calling out a well-known copywriter for making false & unethical claims in his old sales letters. The 'fans' of each side went crazy each defending their man … and much of the copywriting world was drawn into watching the argument and picking a side. Obviously, **when you pick fights, it must be for a good cause.** You must actually be calling out evil or unethical behaviour, and standing for something. Otherwise you're just being a jerk, or a bully. Also note that 'fight' doesn't have to mean a full-fledged war against a single person or entity (though that is the most entertaining kind). You can fight against a philosophy in general, or a group (like my personal feud with r/copywriting). Or you can just write an entertaining take-down of someone's point of view/argument/email (including an email from a reader). On which note:

49. **Trolls, Critics & Haters Are A Gift**
Many people get (understandably) upset by criticism. A nasty email, negative social media post, or 1-star review can ruin anyone's day. But the truth is, **if you want to have a brand that some people love, you must also have a brand some people hate.** Thus, trolls, critics & haters are a sign that you're building the *right* kind of brand to have superfans and loyal customers. Frankly, my email list has grown far more from people saying *bad* things about me than good things. But if you get a criticism that really ruins your day, see the next rule…

50. **"No Private Drama"**
This is a rule I apply in many ways to my business, but one useful application of it is this: **If you receive unsolicited online criticism from some random person that bothers you enough that you can't/don't want to just ignore it, and want/need to say something in response to the person … that response should be PUBLIC.** Most people — when they get a criticism — let it sit in their head and sap their energy all day long, as they spend hours writing & editing some long response which they then send via private email, which does literally NOTHING to benefit them except to gratify the critic or troll with attention. Don't do that. Instead, make it into content and publish it for your entire audience — which not only avoids giving the troll the satisfaction of having gotten a private reply from you, but ALSO will get you a ton of engagement and support from your audience. (I have taught a far more detailed and line-by-line framework for this in *Adventures in Copyland* #17. But a very simple way to do it is to simply write an email like, "I just got this email from a reader…" — then feature the comment — and then close with a few lines, either mocking or criticising what they said, before ending with a pitch for what

you're selling that day. This creates conflict, which is hyper-engaging for your readers, as per Rule #48.)

51. **Never Hard-Sell In Your Emails**
Even when you're selling hard, you must never be needy about it. Instead, **offer people the privilege of buying from you**. This mindset shift is simple but incredibly powerful.

52. **When You Have An Amazing Deal, Get Excited**
If you're offering an amazing deal, but you're writing with low energy, it will show in the copy. You need to come across as excited, energetic and passionate. That means you have to *feel* that way to write it. I remember being a rookie and having Scott Pape send me back to rewrite copy because I turned in copy that tried to *act* excited, rather than actually *being* excited. You need to believe in the product you're selling, and believe that it can help solve the problems of the people you're selling it to.

53. **Ask For Double Opt-In At Sign-Up**
There are cases where single opt-in makes sense. But under my system of email marketing, double opt-in works better. Partly because of the increased lead quality, but also because it lets me optimise the copy people see on the 'confirm your email' page (and the confirmation email itself) before they actually make it onto my list. This page actually has a MUCH higher readership rate than your welcome email — which gives you a great chance to 'warm up' new leads, and filter out those who are bad leads before they even confirm. My course *Optiniser* goes into way more detail on optimising your opt-in process.

54. **Only Ask For An Email Address At Signup**
I used to preach the opposite of this. After all, I'm famous for asking not just for your first name, but your surname AND your phone number! But I now believe that **for most businesses, it makes most sense to only ask for an email at opt-in, and to capture other details — name, phone number, address — after they buy something from you.** Yes, names can help boost open rates (Rule #62) — and they're great for personalisation gags — but you actually don't *need* them to write great emails (Rule #34), so the added friction is often not worth it. Again, if you want to fully understand the reasoning behind all this, and how to set up your opt-in process for best results, check out *Optiniser*.

55. **Why You Should Ignore David Ogilvy's Advice For Subject Lines**
Most people blindly parrot David Ogilvy's quote — about the headline being 80% of the ad spend, etc. — and apply it to email. This isn't wise. Ogilvy was right for his

time. **But subject lines in the inbox to someone on your list are NOT the same as headlines in a newspaper.** If you build a relationship, over time, **your sender name becomes a more important subject line than whatever you have in your subject** — for your regular readers, who are the ones who matter (and who buy your stuff).

56. **The Best Way To Write Subject Lines**
The best way to think of writing subject lines is this: **A subject line must set up a *question* in the reader's mind, and imply the answer is in the email. The more interesting the question you pose, the more likely it will get opened.** To illustrate, here are some examples of subject lines and questions they form (uncredited ones are mine):

- "**How to stop panic attacks with a tennis ball**" >> *"Wait, you can stop a panic attack with a tennis ball?!? How?"*
- "**This is not the email I wanted to send you today**" >> *"Hm? What's inside this email that made him not want to send it? And why did his plans change?"*
- "**The $20 copywriting seminar that saved my business**" (Ben Settle) >> *"What's the $20 copywriting seminar that saved his business?"*
- "**Hey**" (Barack Obama) >> *"Huh? Why is the President sending me a personal email?!? What's it about?"* (Note how the sender name helps form the question!)
- "**Summer breeze, ice cream and sandy shoes**" >> *Example of a subject line that does NOT pose a question and thus is not very good*

This is how I evaluate ALL subject lines (and how I recommend you do, too): I look at it and ask, **"What question does this form in my reader's mind, and how badly would that reader want to know the answer to that question?"**

57. **The Subject Line "Double Whammy" Of Curiosity**
You might have noticed that several of the questions in the previous rule started with the word "Wait" or "Huh?" or "Hang on" or something like that. I did that deliberately. This is a sign that your subject line also included enough novelty or shock value to *surprise* the reader as well as make them curious — making it a double whammy when it comes to getting the email read. (Also, this is why I think my "question" approach to subject lines is more nuanced than the standard "information gap" or "curiosity gap" theory most people talk about.)

58. **Why I ❤️ Long Subject Lines That Don't Even Show Up On Your Phone And Fill The Whole Screen On A Desktop**
Most people avoid long subject lines, but this has never made sense to me. For one thing, long subject lines stand out when everyone else is trying to keep them short. Plus they allow you to put more sensationalism into your headline. Also, when a

subject line is truncated on a phone, it shows with an ellipsis ("...") that adds some inherent curiosity. So if you front-load your subject line with interesting words, you can get the best of both worlds. I've never worried about keeping my subject lines short enough to fit on a mobile screen — and I'm not afraid to write more than 60 characters in a subject line on occasion.

59. **Don't Force A Benefit-Based Subject Line Onto A Story-Based Email**
If you write emails the way I do (and am teaching you in this *Compendium*), one problem you will encounter is writing subject lines for story-based emails that don't really try 'teaching' anything — since they are just an entertaining story and a sales pitch — and whose only real 'value' is the entertainment factor (Rule #5). The truth is … I still struggle with this problem to this day. You simply can't get a good "benefit" subject line from an email that just has a crazy story and a sales pitch. And … that's okay! Like I've just told you, subject lines are overrated if you're following all my rules, since over time your name becomes more important than the subject line (Rule #55). **So on days when my emails contain no 'benefit' other than a story, I will often just tease the story in my subject line instead**, like these recent examples of mine: "*I caught a copywriter PLAGIARISING my homepage and it's time to teach him a little lesson…*" … "*My waiter had ZERO social skills* 😳" … "🚨 *NEW TROLL ALERT!* 🚨" … "*AI got him a copy gig he can't actually do* 🤣" … etc. You get the point. I don't tease any benefit, but I do tease a fun story — and since you already associate my name with those, you want to read it.

60. **Your Subject Line Probably Isn't "Out There" Enough**
A common mistake with subject lines is to not be "out there" enough. You want to find the craziest angle you could possibly exploit. In my *Inbox Detonator Bunker* I have a critique of an email with the subject line "How to have customers begging you to send emails". Yet the lead of the email mentioned dating in passing. So I suggested "Dating advice for business owners". Another had a subject line "Why we don't see the world as it is". I rephrased this to "You're too biased", which is a lot more provocative and in-your-face. **When thinking up subject lines, I am usually looking for the most interesting, weird or unusual angle I can legitimately pull out of the body copy.** (The 'gold standard' example of this I remember is when I was a rookie working with Scott Pape, and he wrote a column about Amazon Prime, which talked about its growing network … fast delivery on essentials like soap and underwear … and the impacts of Amazon on shoppers and workers. My suggestions were standard copywriting-template junk like: *"The tech stock investors can't afford to miss"*, *"The one word you won't find in Amazon's annual report"* and so on. Scott's subject line? "*One-hour undies*". Genius.)

61. **How To "Pre-Test" Your Subject Lines By "Grafting" Them Onto Other People**
If you follow a few email newsletters, there will usually be some you always read … some you read sometimes … some you rarely read … and some you never read. **A trick I came up with to 'pre-test' my subject lines is to take the subject line I'm thinking of using … and spend 5 seconds imagining it got sent to me by someone on the 'rarely' or 'never' list.** Would it get me to open their email? Usually I find that what I thought was a cool subject line … actually wouldn't work in that case. In which case, I try another.

62. **Using Someone's First Name In Subject Lines Boosts Opens, And Using Their Full Name Boosts Opens More, But…**
…don't overdo it. I use names in subject lines sparingly, and honestly, less and less as time goes on. You don't want to be the person that sounds like a bank with subject lines like "Daniel, check out our new savings accounts." "Daniel, we want your feedback." "Daniel, did you Daniel the Daniel on our new Daniel?" (This is one reason I now consider it better for most businesses to not bother capturing names at opt-in, as per Rule #54.) The one exception I've seen to this is my friend Laura Belgray, who uses first-name merge fields in subject lines regularly, yet she is so good at working it naturally into the subject line that it always feels real. But when in doubt, under-doing it is better than overdoing it.

63. **Self-Interest Beats Curiosity**
I've heard it said that curiosity is more powerful than self-interest, but in my experience, self-interest subject lines (promising a direct benefit) generally pull better than curiosity subject lines. For this reason I tend to include the word "copywriting" in many of my subject lines, because it is the one thing I KNOW my audience is interested in (else they wouldn't have opted in).

64. **Unsatisfied Curiosity Turns Into Resentment**
Curiosity is powerful, but remember: **unsatisfied curiosity turns into resentment.** If you tease something and don't pay it off quickly (or worse, don't pay it off at all), people will be mad at you. It's risky to title an email, say, "12 words that close any sale" and then, in the email, say that someone has to buy your product to find out the 12 words. It can be done, but you have to make people *feel* like they got some value or entertainment along the way — otherwise they'll just feel ripped off. In general, make sure you clearly and quickly pay off anything you tease — in a subject line, in a link, or anywhere in your copy.

65. **Join The Conversation In Your Reader's Head**
You've probably heard this phrase, from the Robert Collier Letter Book. The idea is that you should talk about what your reader is already thinking about. That usually means talking about their problems, pains, fears, frustrations and insecurities. Another way is to talk about hot topics that are on the news. But there is one thing to watch out for…

66. **The Double-Edged Sword Of Joining The Conversation In Your Reader's Head**
One of my most-successful emails (judged by the amount of people who took the action I wanted) was called "Why Biden lost", sent after the first US presidential debate in 2020. (Biden was widely considered to have "won" as Trump was rude and brash, hence the interest of my subject line.) But the challenge was that at the end of that email, I was asking people to promote a blog post — yet I was tapping into a very politically-charged topic. The last thing on people's minds, then, would be to share a blog post. **This is the problem you face when you rely on current events to get opens: you focus their emotional state on whatever the news is that you used to get their attention.** So how did I navigate the problem? Well, with a bit of copywriting ninja work. First, I gave my uncommon opinion on the debate and paid off my subject line. Then I pivoted on Trump: I said, "and speaking of Trump …" and smoothly shifted the topic to be about how Trump controls his opponents' attention masterfully. And then, I moved to talking about my blog post on the Parallel Welcome Sequence, which shows how to control your readers' attention. The result was amazing. I had incredible engagement with this email, because I captured a huge amount of traffic with the subject line, and carefully led the reader to my desired action. (Although, in line with the next rule, maybe I shouldn't give too much credit to the email…)

67. **Beware Of Judging An Email By Its Results**
The same email will perform radically differently depending on the timing and context of its sending. A simple "Last chance, sale ends today" email on day 4 of a 4-day sale will generally "outperform" an amazing email sent on day 2, due to the power of the deadline. Any given email will perform differently if you send it to a batch of 1,000 fresh subs vs. if you send it to 1,000 less-fresh subscribers who have been on your list for 3 months (this is why welcome series have high open rates). And even if one email sells really well, it might not have worked so well if you hadn't sent 50 other emails before it over the months leading up to it, that all had a cumulative sales effect. The point? **Looking at the one-off "results" of a single email is almost meaningless without also accounting for the context in which it was sent.** This is why blindly imitating "proven emails" is misleading if you don't know their *context* (there's that pesky Rule #1 again)…

68. **Never Ask Your List To Do Something For Free**
When you ask your list to do something for you, always bribe them with something more valuable than the thing you are asking them to do for you. Do not rely on charity or pity; appeal to their self-interest.

69. **The Ideal Length Of A Welcome Series**
I generally recommend keeping people out of your "live" emails until they've been through a welcome sequence that introduces them to you, your core beliefs, your personality, and the characters in your emails. The downside, of course, is welcome series can feel "canned". My rule is that **your welcome series should only go for as long as the "canned" emails are better than the "fresh" ones you're sending to your "live" email list.** If you have three amazing emails you feel all new subs must read, then use those three. If you have ten, use ten. If you have none, just send one welcome email and then put people onto the live list.

70. **Don't Ask People To Whitelist Your Emails**
Asking people to drag you to the Primary tab — or even worse, add you to their whitelist — has a *very* low compliance rate. **A better way to almost 'automatically' get yourself whitelisted is to get someone to reply to your emails.** Replies are deliverability gold. And the best time to do it is in your welcome email, when someone is warm. But don't just *ask*, like everyone else does. *Bribe* people into answering by offering to respond to them with something they want (see Rule #68). For my own list, I offer a bribe to anyone who replies to my welcome email. (I used to give them the option of just sending a blank reply if they find it awkward to reply to an autoresponder — which many people do — but these days I focus more on building actual relationships, so I ask people to tell me how they found me. But if you JUST want the deliverability boost, saying a blank reply is okay works better.)

71. **Make Selling An EXPECTED Part Of Your Business**
An agency I once worked with had a client who attracted stay-at-home mums and railed against "marketers" often. And guess what? When she tried to launch her first paid course … her market skewered her. They called her out on FB, wrote nasty tweets, labelled her a "sell-out" … and didn't buy. This was HER fault. She'd built a brand where customers did not *expect* to be sold to … and instead, she attracted customers who tried to guilt her for selling. **You should never let your audience feel they have the right to 'shame' you for selling to them.** Think about it: do people walk into a grocery store and shame *them* for selling? Do they turn up their nose in "disappointment" at Woolworths when the Tim Tams are "on sale"? Of course not — because there is an *expectation* that you pay. Grocery stores are in business to make money. **And that's the expectation you need to attach to YOUR brand.** That is why you do not apologise for selling. It emboldens people to shame

you. Make it very clear that you are a business. And the way you do that is by selling proudly in every email you send (Rule #17). Make people expect that's just the way things work with you. Otherwise, when you introduce a sales pitch into your emails, your audience will turn on you.

72. **Humour Is A Great Disguise For Hard Sales Tactics**
One way to subtly 'indoctrinate' your audience into accepting more selling is to use humour to disguise it. Personally, I constantly joke about how hard I am going to sell to people, and how excited I am about that. It's why comedy is one of the few areas where it's still okay to not be politically correct: **Humour lowers people's defences to ideologies they wouldn't normally tolerate** — including heavy salesmanship.

73. **Don't Segment Out Buyers**
I'm not against segmenting in all cases, as it obviously has its place. But in general, I don't 'segment out' buyers from receiving emails about products they already own. Firstly, because your emails should be so interesting and valuable that people enjoy getting them even if they already own the product. But more importantly, because **by sending buyers sales emails, you re-sell them on actually *using* the product they bought!** Most people never use products they buy — whether info (a course) or a physical product (an Ab King Pro). So if you have a *good* product that will actually help people if they use it, you do them a favour by continuing to sell. I have had many people tell me they bought this very *Compendium* you're reading now … but only got around to actually reading it after seeing several more emails for it, sometimes months down the line.

74. **How To Sell Luxury Goods With Emails**
An *Inbox Detonator* student once asked me about how to sell luxury goods with copywriting. He pointed out that "simply describing the technical details doesn't seem great either, like the number of facets, etc." I disagreed. A lot of effective copy for high-end items DOES focus on things like the number of facets. Look at any Apple sales page and the focus on chips and transistors, etc. Or the ads in magazines for premium coins or collectibles. But more effectively, with luxury goods it is the idea, the story, the image behind it. There are a few ways to do this. **You can tell the painstaking story of how the item is created.** Show the effort that goes into it; the purity of the material; the craftsmanship; the rarity of what's in it. **You can show the kind of people who use it.** Usually this is by association with celebrities or something, but you can also have images of 'tough guys', 'exotic Europeans', etc. (Example: There was a story about a question in the application process for Ogilvy & Mather. Applicants were asked how they would sell a penny for more than a penny. One person came up with the idea of dipping the coin into

Marilyn Monroe's handbag and then selling it as a coin owned by Marilyn Monroe.) **Or you can do both.** Peak Design with their Everyday Backpack did an excellent job of this. They told both the painstaking story of the craftsmanship and clever design of the product; and also stuffed their marketing with images of cool people doing cool things wearing the bags. The end goal is to let the prospect tell themselves a story about why they own it. I bought one of those bags, and every time I put it on I remind myself about all the features it has, and I see myself as one of those cool people. If you have *Market Detective*, I go into this a lot more in the 'identity' part of market profiling.

75. **How To Sell Wine With Emails**
(Or any other physical product! Wine just made for a nice curious headline…) One of the most powerful ways to sell physical goods — cheese, bicycles, fruit, hammers, jackets, houses — is to use **word-painting**. If you follow my emails, this is something you *won't* see me do much, since I only sell info-products! But **to sell a physical product through emails, you must use vivid prose that engages as many senses as possible**, as the customer can't see/taste/smell/touch the product like they would in a store. Let's take wine. Talk about the cool, breezy vineyards where the grapes were picked. Describe the smell of the musty oak barrels where the wine is aged for years. Paint the scene of the reader pouring a glass and watching the brilliant red hue that shows the grapes were picked in their prime. Describe the scent of oak and plum as they gently smell the aroma from the glass. Talk about the fiery notes of cinnamon and chocolate that dance across the palate as they take a sip and swill it across their tongue. This is one of those tricks that works just as well in emails as it did in direct-mail letters 100 years ago, so go to town with it — it's almost impossible to overdo it, really. In *Adventures in Copyland* #15 I went a lot deeper on other techniques for selling physical goods using emails, not just word-painting.

76. **How To Sell Art With Emails**
An artist once asked me how she could write sales emails since what she sells — art — does not solve a "problem" for anyone. In this case — common with artists/authors/musicians etc. — you must focus on selling the relationship, not the product. And then follow these pointers: **Firstly**, make sure your email list targets your previous buyers. People buy more of what they just bought. Your previous buyers are the best place to go. **Secondly**, you can broaden your net by thinking about what other kinds of things that people who like art want: Home decoration? Art buying guides? Commentary on what's going on in the world of art? **Thirdly**, artists have an advantage someone like me doesn't have: TRUE scarcity. You can say, "*I painted this one this morning … It evokes ___ … Perfect for the person who ___ … Would look amazing in your beach house or a sunny wall in a well lit spacious living room.*

I'm listing this one for $500. First bidder can have it." (Note the word-painting!) **Finally**, in any field you don't only sell to your customers … but you will likely have competitors watching you. In the early days of my list I was writing emails to clients, but I knew I had a TON of copywriters following my emails. So I played to that and began selling them offers! Likewise, you can also attract artists who are watching what you do, and sell them offers for artists.

77. **Should You Assume People Have Read Your Previous Emails?**
Yes and no. In the original version of this *Compendium*, I taught that it's never a good idea to assume someone remembers what you said, or even cares: "If you absolutely must refer to a previous email, recap it or link to it. But it's better to make emails stand alone." However, as time goes on I'm personally focusing more on cultivating the 'super-fans' of my brand that actually *do* read almost all my emails, since these people make up the majority of my actual *customers*. So my current strategy is this: **I will make in-jokes and references to events in my "brand history" for people who have been following along … while still also giving a bit of quick "intro context" each time I do, to allow new people to get "in" on the joke.**

78. **It's Okay (Actually, It's Best!) To Email Daily**
From a reader's perspective, there is absolutely no reason you cannot email as much as daily, if you're interesting. Think about it: every morning, someone wakes up. It is a new day. They read a new edition of the newspaper. They listen to the daily edition of their favourite talk show. They check their emails. These things are all 'refreshed' each day, and you have a new chance. Nobody wakes up and thinks, "gee, I read something from X yesterday, so I need a day off reading them today". If you want to email less than daily, that's fine, but don't project your insecurities onto your reader. **They read plenty of things daily. You just need to be interesting enough to be one of them.** Note: this doesn't mean daily emails are the best for every business in every case. They're time-consuming and for some lists, just don't make sense. But don't resist them just because you think it's "too many emails for someone to read".

79. **How Long Should Writing An Email Take?**
It depends. I've researched and written 5 sales emails, from scratch, in 30 minutes — for a market I knew NOTHING about. (The full screen recording of this challenge is in my *Market Detective* course.) On the other hand, some of my highest-effort daily emails (think long, funny or crazy stories, super-thoughtful pieces, or epic troll beatdowns) can take me 2, 3, or even 4 hours to perfect! However, that is definitely not the norm (and besides, those emails are the ones that have 100x payoff because people remember them for years). **In general, I think 30-60 minutes is a reasonable amount of time for an email in a market you are familiar**

with. (Some AI shills will brag about how they can write 50 emails in that time, but I regularly crush AI-using copywriters in head-to-head email sales contests, so the 'time they save' by using AI seems like a false economy to me.) If you have to research the market, it might take longer, but under no circumstances do I think it's reasonable to take more than 2 hours on a single email (unless it's super creative and epic). If it's taking you that long, you're weak on your research game, and you need to get to know your market more and understand their pains (and the solutions that your product provides to those pains).

80. **You Can Reuse Emails, But Be Careful**
Personally, I almost *never* reuse an email (I can count on one hand the number of times I've done it, and even then I always dress it up with a new 'twist' like a new lead). But I'm not against it. **I just don't like doing it any more frequently than once a year.** At that frequency, people can *just* put their finger on the fact that they saw this email or promo before, but they've forgotten what it said. If you do it every few months (like some brands I know), readers get tired of it, and resentful of you for not respecting their time.

81. **The Ideal Open Rate Is…**
…a trick question. Don't trust anyone who tries to give you a hard-and-fast number (remember Rule #1)? The current trend is that open rates are becoming less and less reliable over time as more and more mail providers block or fudge open rate data. There is no 'universal' open rate that is reasonable to expect for everyone. **The ONLY hard-and-fast rule about open rates is this: Open rates are only useful in the context of split-tests to the same list around the same time.** Even on the same list, I don't compare open rates on emails that were sent more than a few months apart.

82. **Multiply Your Feedback By 50x**
I like to use this rule of thumb to put feedback in context: **For every person who sends you an email telling you something, there are 50 people who felt the same but didn't bother to say it.** Sending a reply is hard and risky (especially if they're saying something you don't want to hear), so you need to take that into account when you get feedback. Don't fall into the trap of only looking at absolute numbers.

83. **Don't Watch Your Subscribers Too Closely**
Before I was more well-known, I used to watch who was subscribing to my emails, and got excited when "famous" copywriters joined. Some of them would later unsubscribe and it rattled me because I took it personally. Over time I realised how pointless it was to keep track of these things. It makes no money, and it's only ever

going to upset you. And besides…

84. **Unsubscribes Are A Good Thing**
You need to get comfortable with unsubscribes — and even see them as a good thing. Unsubscribes clean your list. Unsubscribes lower your spend on subs who weren't going to buy. Unsubscribes help your deliverability by not sending to non-readers. Unsubscribes mean you're emailing enough (or being controversial enough) to bother people — which means you're making fans out of others. If you worry about unsubscribes, you'll write bland and inoffensive emails and you'll act fearful and needy. Get comfortable with unsubscribes and your emails will become much, much better.

85. **It's All About The Bullets? Bulldust.**
Don't stuff emails with bullets. Bullets tempt you to get lazy and list 'what you get' instead of 'what's in it for me' (see Rule #93). SO many copywriters launch products with an array of bullets of "what you get": *"24/7 access to our private Facebook group!" "Weekly live chats!" "Unlimited access to our training dashboard!" "BONUS private Q&A session!"* This is terrible copywriting. Besides, in today's skimming age, people have ADD. They want copy to be new, new, new. And I mean, even every few *lines*. The argument has to go somewhere new to keep them interested. **When you get to a list of bullets, it is an instant sign to your brain that no development in the argument is coming. That is why your eye hits bullets and automatically 'skips' to the bottom of that bulleted list most of the time.** In fact, often bullets are (ironically) a way to tell people what NOT to read, because you can see the endpoint to skip to. So use them sparingly. (Note, this is a rule I apply mostly to EMAIL. I still use bullets on my sales letters. But I try to imagine people are in hardcore 'skim' mode when they're reading emails.)

86. **Stop Being A Copywriter. Be A Human Being.**
I reviewed a cart abandonment sequence for a fat-loss supplement, targeted at middle-aged women, from an *Inbox Detonator* student. It followed a lot of the "best practices". It had a headline like "This Product Is In Your Cart … But It Would Rather Be Burning Your Fat!" and a huge list of benefits. And the follow-up emails said things like "Have you given up on losing fat?" It all came across as very copywriter-y, using "persuasion hacks" to push people over the edge. And … it sounded gross. I suggested rewriting the sequence, imagining that we actually were a close friend of the prospect. Would a 50-year-old woman write like a salesman? Heck no. She'd write something like this: *"hey!!! I saw a report from my system today and you didn't end up checking out with those pills! Is there anything wrong? Any questions I can answer? Otherwise you can quickly check out with them here: <LINK> I know you might feel some doubt. But trust me when you see how these*

shed fat … you will be amazed. I've got 'em saved for ya, hon. Just click here. Amy x" **Sometimes, you need to stop thinking like a copywriter, and think more like a human being.**

87. **Your Emails Are A Privilege To Receive**
If you write emails the way I am teaching you with these rules, your emails will be extremely entertaining, valuable, insightful, fun, and the highlight of many of your subscribers' day. What's more, they will be totally unique and one-of-a-kind, since by definition there is only one of YOU, and so your subscribers cannot get what you offer anywhere else. You should realise this, and **adopt this attitude towards your emails: "My emails are a PRIVILEGE to receive."** You should NOT consider your subscribers to be "doing you a favour" by reading you or "giving the gift of their attention". No! **The world is *full* of potential subscribers like them. But there is only ONE place where *they* can get *your* emails.** This mindset changes everything about the way you do email, from your opt-in process, to your tone and attitude, to the way you handle subscribers who annoy or disrespect you — simply kick them off your list.

88. **The Optimum Length Of An Email Sales Promotion**
Having spent years writing many of the most successful email sales promotions in the industry (and in other industries) … my recommendation is to **keep email promos between 2 and 5 days in length**. Beyond 5 days, you're just going to tire people out from your sale, and (to avoid burnout) you have to drop your email volume down so low it won't even stand out. On the other hand, once you go less than 2-3 days, you'll start to get people saying they didn't see the emails (they were on vacation, or took a break from their inbox for a few days, etc.). I think 4 or 5 days long is probably best for most email lists that are afraid to email more than 1-2 times per day over that time. But that doesn't mean you can't tease a product *before* it's available for buying … even many months in advance.

89. **Start A Sale By Being Up-Front**
When you start an email sale, in your first email, just be up-front about it. Tell people the sale is starting; the details of the offer; what's in the product; and how long the sale is going. This is the place to give detail, and catch the people who are ready to buy immediately. All the emails after that are reminders.

90. **Being Front-Of-Mind > An Awesome Sales Argument**
When you're doing a sale, **it's better to stay front-of-mind with your audience, and keep reminding them you have a sale, than it is to try and make the most persuasive sales argument in each email.** Remember, most of the selling is done by the relationship you have with your list *before* the sale starts. Also, the main reason

good prospects don't buy things is that it's usually easier to *not* buy than it is to buy. Buying is psychologically uncomfortable, and most on-the-fence people don't want to decide until the end of the sale, when the deadline will force them. Plus, it's easy for someone to get distracted quickly after seeing a sales email. Thus, your best bet is to stay in front of them as much as possible, to try and catch them at a moment they might actually be able and willing to buy — or if not, to keep reminding them of your sales message, bit-by-bit, until they confront the deadline. Hopefully, by that point, your *cumulative* sales message (delivered over multiple emails) is strong enough to get them to commit.

91. **What To Write About During A Sale**
If you're following all the other rules in this *Compendium* for writing emails, the truth is the emails you send are going to be pretty similar whether you have a sale going or not. **The main changes I make to my emails when running a sale are a) obviously, sending more often; b) deliberately picking stories or leads that make a stronger sales case, rather than a weak one (see Rule #18); c) having a stronger CTA; and d) in some (not all) of the emails throughout the sale, I'll usually include an extra reminder of the sale early on in the lead of the email (like "Since there are only 3 days left in this sale…") so people are reminded even if they don't read it all.** I also might throw in a few more 'salesy' emails throughout the sale, simply talking about what a great deal it is, or drilling down into one aspect of the offer.

92. **How Many Emails Can You Send In A Day?**
This depends on the length of your sale window, and also how aggressive you're willing to get. If you're doing anything more than 5 days, you may want to stick to an email a day for most of it until the last day. Anything less and I would do 2-3 emails per day — with a handful more on the final day. On the final day, you can do anywhere from 3 to … well, it depends how fun you make 'em, and how aggressive you're willing to be. In *Campaign Conqueror* I actually have a reference chart for working out exactly how many emails to send on different days based on various factors about your list, but I think my personal record is 9 emails in the final 24 hours (okay, so I might have gotten a *little* carried away that day)…

93. **Mix It Up**
If I mail more than once in a day, I like to split it so that there's a mix of more 'salesy' emails and more 'value-based' emails. (To be clear, the 'value' emails still *sell* stuff; they just contain a little more meat.)

94. **"Free Taste" Emails Are For Rookies**
When copywriters run out of ideas for an info-product launch they often revert to a "free taste" email where they give away a portion of the product for free. I've

tried this and it never seems to work well. Refer to Rule #7 — people don't value what they don't pay for. You do your information (and customers) a disservice to give it away free. Also, 99% of the time, **information is far less sexy than the sales copy you use to sell it** (and there's nothing wrong with that — all good info is pretty unsexy, but you need to sell people into paying for it for them to value and apply it). So it generally backfires as a sales strategy to give away pure value. Finally, by giving away value, you're literally devaluing the product by reducing the amount of "exclusive" info people get if they buy it.

95. **Expect Sales To Be Back-Loaded**
In an email campaign, **you'll generally get ⅓ to ½ of your sales in the final 24 hours** — provided you remind people strongly about the deadline. The exception is when you're launching something to a pre-order list, or something that has been heavily teased for a long time. In these cases, you'll get most of your sales the moment you open the doors.

96. **Write Your Emails Live**
A lot of people like to pre-write and schedule their sales campaigns ahead of time. I have never done this; I've always preferred to write emails live, on the day I send them. In fact, **99% of the emails I have ever sent to my list have been written on the same day I sent them.** There are a few reasons for this. Firstly, writing live (especially during a sales promo) allows you to react quickly to any questions or tech issues that come up, which make for really good fodder. Secondly, it lets you use more fresh, real-time material instead of stale, pre-written hooks, which is always more effective. But the biggest reason is this: email marketing should be a relationship (Rule #16). **But could you have a relationship with someone in real life where you pre-programmed the next 30, 60, or 90 days of communications with them into an autoresponder?** It's absolutely *unthinkable* that you would have a functioning relationship with another human being if you did that in real life. And yet stupid marketers get so caught up with the "make money on autopilot" mindset that they don't realise how dumb it is to apply it to email. I have absolutely DESTROYED pretty much everyone else of note in the copywriting world in head-to-head email promotions — and this is one of my biggest secrets, because my relationship with my list is just so *powerful*, whereas everyone else is sending emails that feel like they could have been written months ago. Ignore it at your peril…

97. **FAQ Emails Are Stupid (Unless You Make Them Fun)**
Who in history has ever wanted to read an FAQ email? There is nothing that says "don't read me" more than the subject line "Your questions, answered" or "FAQs about X". If you must do one, at least make it FUN. Once I put a fun twist on this for

Mia Freedman. She had an FAQ email. I suggested instead we make it a dialogue between "2020 Mia" and "2005 Mia" (or whenever it was). 2005 Mia would list all her objections one-by-one, and 2020 Mia would answer them. But we filled the dialogue with personality and pop culture references from the years, which made it entertaining. That's one way to get away with it (and another good example of using entertainment to 'sneak' sales pitches past someone). Instead of putting your FAQs into a single FAQ email, I advise putting them on the sales letter, and sprinkling your FAQs through multiple emails (one FAQ can make a good hook for a single email…)

98. **Always Send A 'Last Call' Email**
There are always some people hanging around on the sales page till the final minutes. A short 'last call' email is always a good idea to get these people off the fence. I generally do this from 1-3 hours before the sale ends. I also like to put this info in the subject line of this one, so people don't have to open the email to get the reminder (e.g. I'd use the subject line "Last chance to get 33% off any copywriting course I sell").

99. **Breathe. People Don't Hate You**.
It can still be scary to send more than one email in a day (or even one email a day!) until you realise that … most people are antipathic towards multiple emails. They just read them and move on, or don't open them. They don't get mad. It's not that big a deal.

100. **Okay, *Some* People Hate You.**
No matter how many emails you send, there will always be someone who thinks it's too many. So … do you want that to happen at one email per week — where few people buy your stuff — or at once per day, when you're going to make a lot more sales and build a better relationship with your best readers? Remember, someone will hate you either way, so don't let them sway your decision.

101. **"Most Things Don't Matter."**
This is one of the most powerful lessons I have learned: **Most things don't matter.** That's particularly important when you make a mistake or mess something up. Most people will forget in a matter of weeks, if not days. If you said something bad, probably only a small proportion of your list saw it. If you forgot to replace the <name> merge field with someone's name in an email, they'll get over it. If you accidentally send out an email without a link, just send another one with the link. Or don't. Most things don't matter.

Compendium Quick-Reference Guide

1. The Most Important Word In Copywriting Is…
2. The Elements Of Must-Read Marketing Email Lists
3. Before You Send Any Email, Ask This
4. Never Sell Out Your List
5. "Value" Does Not Mean "Teaching"
6. More Info Does Not Equal More Value
7. If You Want To Help Someone, Make Them Pay
8. The Goal Of Email Marketing: To Build "Know, Like, Trust, Revere"
9. The Ideal Email Length
10. A Word Count Is A Lyin' Thing
11. Are You Smarter Than A 5th Grader? Don't Be
12. The THREE Hurdles To Getting Your Email Read
13. The Second Hurdle To Getting Your Email Read
14. The Third Hurdle To Getting Your Email Read
15. Emails Are Not Sales Letters
16. Good Email Marketing Is An (Asymmetrical) Relationship
17. Sell In Every Email
18. Don't Sell Hard In Every Email
19. Readers WANT To See "You" In Your Emails
20. Make Characters Of The People In Your Life
21. Readers Should Know You Better After Every Email
22. Caricature Everyone — Including Yourself
23. Don't "Be You" When You're Writing Emails
24. A Weird Trick To Psychologically Abuse Your Readers Into Revering You
25. Exaggeration Is The Most Amazing, Incredible Technique In The History Of Storytelling
26. Write Emails "Based On A True Story"
27. Always Be On The Lookout For Story Ideas
28. The "Triforce" Of Email Leads: Relevant, Entertaining, Brief
29. Not Every Sales Email Needs A Fresh Personal Story
30. The Sitcom Secret Behind Telling Great Stories In Emails
31. Finding The Balance Between Telling Stories About Yourself And Talking About The Reader
32. The "Small Business Owner Model" For Relationship-Based Emails
33. Regular Broadcasts Are Best Written Backwards
34. Don't "Write Like You're Writing To A Friend"
35. Don't Use Questions In Sales Emails
36. How To Use Stories To Sell
37. How To Never Run Out Of Email Ideas, Part I
38. How To Never Run Out Of Email Ideas, Part II
39. How To Never Run Out Of Email Ideas, Part III
40. How To Never Run Out Of Email Ideas, Part IV
41. The Simple Email Opener For Using Other People's Stories In Sales Emails
42. Elevate People's Thinking
43. Use Pain And Fear To Sell Like Hell (Literally)
44. Make Your Emails Taste Like Diet Coke
45. Don't Make People Feel Bad In Emails
46. Uh … Make People Feel Bad In Emails?
47. Don't Show Weakness
48. Fights Get More Attention Than Anything Else
49. Trolls, Critics & Haters Are A Gift
50. "No Private Drama"
51. Never Hard-Sell In Your Emails
52. When You Have An Amazing Deal, Get Excited
53. Ask For Double Opt-In At Sign-Up
54. Only Ask For An Email Address At Signup
55. Why You Should Ignore David Ogilvy's Advice For Subject Lines
56. The Best Way To Write Subject Lines
57. The Subject Line "Double Whammy" Of Curiosity
58. Why I ❤️ Long Subject Lines That Don't Even Show Up On Your Phone
59. Don't Force A Benefit-Based Subject Line Onto A Story-Based Email
60. Your Subject Line Probably Isn't "Out There" Enough
61. How To "Pre-Test" Your Subject Lines By "Grafting" Them Onto Other People
62. Using Someone's First Name In Subject Lines Boosts Opens, But Be Careful
63. Self-Interest Beats Curiosity
64. Unsatisfied Curiosity Turns Into Resentment
65. Join The Conversation In Your Reader's Head
66. The Double-Edged Sword Of Joining The Conversation In Your Reader's Head
67. Beware Of Judging An Email By Its Results
68. Never Ask Your List To Do Something For Free
69. The Ideal Length Of A Welcome Series
70. Don't Ask People To Whitelist Your Emails
71. Make Selling An EXPECTED Part Of Your Business
72. Humour Is A Great Disguise For Hard Sales Tactics
73. Don't Segment Out Buyers
74. How To Sell Luxury Goods With Emails
75. How To Sell Wine With Emails
76. How To Sell Art With Emails
77. Should You Assume People Have Read Your Previous Emails?
78. It's Okay (Actually, It's Best!) To Email Daily
79. How Long Should Writing An Email Take?
80. You Can Reuse Emails, But Be Careful
81. The Ideal Open Rate Is…
82. Multiply Your Feedback By 50x
83. Don't Watch Your Subscribers Too Closely
84. Unsubscribes Are A Good Thing
85. It's All About The Bullets? Bulldust.
86. Stop Being A Copywriter. Be A Human Being.
87. Your Emails Are A Privilege To Receive
88. The Optimum Length Of An Email Sales Promotion
89. Start A Sale By Being Up-Front
90. Being Front-Of-Mind > An Awesome Sales Argument
91. What To Write About During A Sale
92. How Many Emails Can You Send In A Day?
93. Mix It Up
94. "Free Taste" Emails Are For Rookies
95. Expect Sales To Be Back-Loaded
96. Write Your Emails Live
97. FAQ Emails Are Stupid (Unless You Make Them Fun)
98. Always Send A 'Last Call' Email
99. Breathe. People Don't Hate You.
100. Okay, Some People Hate You.
101. "Most Things Don't Matter."

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Aaaaaand there you have it. These tips have taken a great deal of time, effort and money to learn — and they've repaid me in kind. I hope they do the same for you too.

I recommend printing a copy of this report out and keeping it handy (printers were invented in your day, right? I'm getting old now, I can't remember). I'm not kidding when I say I use these rules in **EVERY** email I write.

And, past-Daniel, if you're keen for some more training to level up your copy skills ...

Then bookmark this URL, which in the future, will direct you to a treasure-trove of amazing copywriting training far beyond anything I could fit in a PDF report:

persuasivepage.com/products

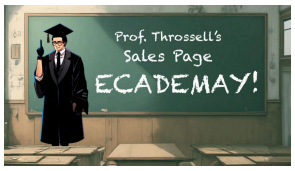
(Or just see the offers on the next page, come to think of it...)

Your Future Self,
Daniel Throssell

More Products By Daniel Throssell:

The hilarious, all-digital newsletter stuffed with my newest & best copywriting tactics — delivered to your phone each month! Subscribe to my flagship digital copywriting newsletter: https://persuasivepage.com/adventures-in-copyland

Learn my system for winning highly-paid copywriting work on Upwork — in just one hour. Get the counterintuitive strategy I used to go from ZERO copywriting experience to charging $200/hr on Upwork in 9 months. In a course you can binge in just one hour. https://persuasivepage.com/upwork



Almost all my best sales letter training, now in one place. A collection of dozens of hard-to-find sales letters I have written (for myself and clients), along with 14 hours of bite-sized sales page tactics, line-by-line copy teardowns of my own sales letters, and fully narrated behind-the-scenes "live write" videos. https://pers.page/ecademay

How I write email campaigns that regularly outsell the world's best copywriters. My full framework for writing product launches, sales campaigns, affiliate promotions, book launches, and all kinds of other email campaigns. https://persuasivepage.com/campaign-conqueror

My world-first "staged" approach to market research for freelance copywriters. The only market research system in the world that doesn't just tell you to "KnOW eVeRyThInG" about your market — but instead tells you exactly when you can STOP researching. https://persuasivepage.com/market-detective

The world's ONLY list-building framework designed specifically for copywriters. How to grow a small-but-profitable list full of subscribers who love you, promote you, and buy all the (quality) offers you sell … so you can supplement or replace your client income. https://persuasivepage.com/email-celebrity

How to create courses your customers love — and love to buy. The exact course design model I use to consistently create the best courses in the copywriting industry. https://persuasivepage.com/genius

Spy on my expensive private copy coaching — for a fraction of what my students pay. The closest thing to mentoring under me: a full backstage pass to watch ALL of my coaching sessions (past, present and future) for a single, once-off payment. behind-the-scenes "live write" videos. https://persuasivepage.com/bunker

Everything I know about designing high-converting upsell funnels — delivered in less than one hour. A comprehensive course in crafting a BRUTAL upsell funnel that has your customers lovingly CURSING your name as they pay you more … and more … and MORE!!! https://pers.page/upsells

How to tell addictive stories in your sales emails. A collection of training on some of my best & most useful tactics for email storytelling to entertain & SELL. https://pers.page/storyteller

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